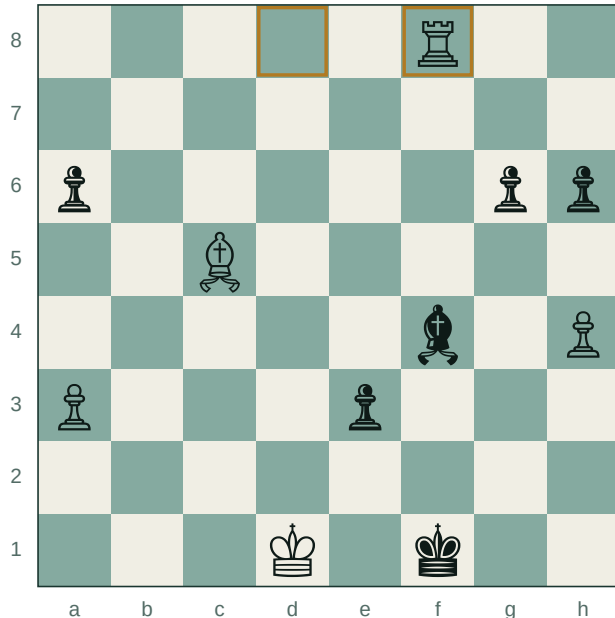


Active defensive resources: Black, move 46

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 46.Rf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

46...e2+ 47. Kc2 e1=Q 48. Rxf4+ Kg2

46...e2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **47.Kc2**.

47...e1=Q The pawn moves from e2 to e1. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **48.Rxf4+**.

48...Kg2 The king moves from f1 to g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on d1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c5. Check for tactical protection.